

FORKLIFT SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Control overturning, collision and dropped-load hazards.

8-10 MINUTES

OBJECTIVE

Review forklift hazards including overturning, collisions, dropped loads, blind spots and pedestrian safety while applying safe operating practices.

TOPIC EXPLANATION

- Only trained and authorised operators may operate forklifts. Complete daily inspections before use.
- Carry loads low, stable and within rated capacity. Use reverse travel or a spotter when the load blocks visibility.
- Wear the seat belt, obey site speed limits and always give way to pedestrians.

REALISTIC SITE SCENARIO

- An operator travelled forward with a load blocking visibility.
- A pedestrian entered the intersection and the operator braked suddenly, causing the load to shift.
- The incident could have been prevented through reverse travel, a spotter and correct load positioning.

REMEMBER

A forklift is a material handling vehicle, not a personnel carrier.

FORKLIFT SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Hazards, safe driving practices and daily pre-work verification.

8-10 MINUTES

KEY HAZARDS

- Overturning
- Dropped loads
- Blind spots
- Pedestrian collisions
- Overloading
- Excessive speed
- No seat belt
- Unauthorised operators

CONTROL MEASURES

- Complete the daily inspection.
- Use authorised operators only.
- Wear the seat belt.
- Carry loads low.
- Use reverse travel or a spotter if visibility is blocked.
- Follow pedestrian controls.
- Obey speed limits.
- Lower forks before parking.
- Apply the parking brake.
- Remove defective forklifts from service.

SUPERVISOR TALKING SCRIPT

Today we will verify daily inspections, ensure seat belts are worn, keep loads low and use spotters where visibility is limited. Pedestrians always have priority.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- Has the daily inspection been completed?
- Is the operator authorised?
- Is visibility restricted?
- Is a spotter required?
- Are pedestrian routes protected?
- How will the forklift be parked safely?

VERIFY BEFORE STARTING TODAY

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Authorised operator | ☐ Inspection complete |
| ☐ Brakes OK | ☐ Horn working |
| ☐ Alarm working | ☐ Forks OK |
| ☐ Load secure | ☐ Seat belt worn |
| ☐ Pedestrian routes clear | ☐ Safe parking area |

ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

FORKLIFT SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Project / Site

Date

Presented by

Work area

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
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Supervisor notes